own courtiers. Salim brought fabulous gifts with him as peshkash, including a diamond worth a lakh of rupees, 200 elephants, and trays full of gold mohurs. All Salim's courtiers similarly presented themselves, and offered gifts. Conspicuous by his absence was Muhammad Sharif, who had been sent as ambassador by Akbar to Allahabad, but who had then betrayed the Padshah's cause. Muhammad Sharif would stay away from Agra till Salim became Padshah, unable to face Akbar's disapproval and disappointment.

Akbar hugged his son and received him with warmth in the diwane-aam but later appeared convulsed by distress which would not be contained. He had Salim arrested and brought to him and struck him on the face, upbraiding him for all the intolerable crimes he had committed. Salim hung his head in shame and fear, weeping. Akbar had him imprisoned for a few days in the inner apartments, and forbade the servants from bringing him any wine. All the while, Salim's sisters rushed from father to son, attempting to bring peace and, eventually, Akbar forgave Salim, brought opium to the abject prince himself, and restored his lands and command to him.

That Akbar was conflicted over the decision to forgive Salim is clear, the murder of Abu'l Fazl still an unresolved and festering wound between them. But Akbar was running out of choices for an heir to the Mughal throne, for the reports from the Deccan about Daniyal's alcoholism were increasingly dire. Akbar had appointed guardians to watch over Daniyal and keep him away from alcohol but his companions found ways to smuggle in wine nonetheless, sometimes inside gun barrels, and sometimes in the bladders of animals. When Abdur Rahim managed to enforce the ban, Daniyal began to weep, and implored his servants to 'let them bring me wine in any possible way'. He called his musketeer, Murshid Quli Khan, and gave him his favourite gun and told him to bring some wine inside it. The musketeer did as he was bid, and 'poured double-distilled spirit into the gun, which had long been nourished on gunpowder and the scent thereof, and brought it. The rust of the iron was dissolved by the strength of the spirit and mingled with it, and the prince no sooner drank of it than he fell down.' Daniyal died of alcohol poisoning on 11 March 1605, at the age of thirty-three. It is not an impossibility, though, that Salim managed to have his brother poisoned. Daniyal's dependence on alcohol was well-known, and it would have been relatively easy for Salim, with his wide network of allies, to have poison slipped into his drink. We are told that Daniyal's